

Home > Travel > Busan



Busan Travel Guide 2026

Korea's second city — dramatic beaches, fresh seafood straight from the ocean, colorful hillside villages, and a laid-back coastal energy you won't find in Seoul.

3.4M

Population

2h 20m

From Seoul (KTX)

7

Major Beaches

Oct

Best Month



Top Attractions



Haeundae Beach

Korea's most famous beach — bustling in summer, peaceful in autumn. Backed by luxury hotels and seafood restaurants.



Gamcheon Culture Village

Busan's most photogenic spot — colorful houses cascading down a hillside, with street art, tiny galleries and cafes tucked in every corner.



Jagalchi Fish Market



Gwanghan Bridge

Korea's largest seafood market — pick your live fish, have it prepared right there and eat it fresh with soju and side dishes.

A stunning 7.4km suspension bridge — best viewed from Gwangalli Beach at night when it's lit up in colors.



Haedong Yonggungsa Temple

A rare seaside Buddhist temple built on dramatic coastal cliffs — stunning at sunrise and during the lotus lantern festival.



Taejongdae Park

Dramatic coastal cliffs at Busan's southern tip — a lighthouse, rocky coastline, and sweeping views of the Korea Strait.

What to Eat in Busan

Busan's food scene is defined by the sea. The city has its own distinct dishes you won't find as easily in Seoul.



Millak Raw Fish (횃집)

Fresh sashimi-style fish at Millak Waterside Park — the local way to eat seafood.



Dongnae Pajeon (동래파전)

Busan's famous green onion pancake loaded with seafood — crispy, chewy perfection.



Oden / Odeng (어묵)

Fish cake on a stick in hot broth — a beloved Busan street food, especially in winter.



Dwaeji Gukbap (돼지국밥)

Pork and rice soup — Busan's signature comfort food, eaten for breakfast by locals.



Nakji Bokkeum (낙지볶음)

Spicy stir-fried octopus — a Busan specialty that's fiery and deeply flavorful.



BIFF Square Hotteok (씨앗호떡)

Sweet pancakes stuffed with seeds, brown sugar and honey — a must at the street stalls.

Where to eat: Jagalchi Market for raw seafood · Gukje Market for street food · BIFF Square for hotteok and snacks · Seomyeon for late-night Korean BBQ



Getting to Busan from Seoul



KTX Bullet Train — Recommended

Seoul Station → Busan Station in **2 hours 20 minutes**. Trains run every 20–30 minutes from 5am to midnight. Book on Korail or the SRT app. Cost: ~₩59,800 (economy).



Domestic Flight

Gimpo (Seoul) → Gimhae (Busan). ~1 hour flight but factoring in airport time, KTX is usually faster and cheaper.



Express Bus

Seoul Express Bus Terminal → Busan Central Bus Terminal. ~4.5 hours. Cheapest option (~₩23,000) but slower.



Getting Around Busan

LOCAL TRANSPORT

- **Metro (지하철)** — 4 lines covering most attractions. T-money card works.
- **Bus** — Extensive network, but harder for tourists to navigate. T-money card works.
- **Taxi** — Very affordable. KakaoTaxi app recommended. Base fare: ~₩4,800.
- **Busan City Tour Bus** — Hop-on hop-off covering all major sights. Great for first-timers.



Best Time to Visit

BY SEASON

- **Spring (Mar–May)** — Cherry blossoms at Nakdonggang River, warm and uncrowded
- **Summer (Jun–Aug)** — Beach season, very hot and crowded, Haeundae Sand Festival in July
- **Autumn (Sep–Nov)** — Best weather, foliage at Geumjeongsan, Busan International Film Festival (October)
- **Winter (Dec–Feb)** — Quietest and cheapest, good for seafood, fewer tourists



Useful Korean Phrases in Busan

해운대 어떻게 가요? *hae-un-dae eo-tteo-ke ga-yo?* How do I get to Haeundae?

생선 얼마예요? *saeng-seon eol-ma-ye-yo?* How much is the fish?

신선해요? *sin-seon-hae-yo?* Is it fresh?

돼지국밥 주세요. *dwae-ji guk-bap ju-se-yo.* One pork soup, please.

부산역이 어디예요? *bu-san-yeok-i eo-di-ye-yo?* Where is Busan Station?

Planning your Korea trip?

Learn the Korean you need before you go — 41 chapters from beginner to advanced.

Try Free — Ch.1~5

Travel Conversations →

[Home](#) [Travel](#) [Seoul Guide](#) [Jeju Guide](#) [Contact](#)

© 2026 KR Guide. All rights reserved.